peninsular, and archipelagic landforms. Japan's control of Korea and Formosa (now Taiwan) in the 1930s facilitated its invasion of China, which found its greatest success in the rimland and only became bogged down when it attempted to extend into China's heartland or out into the trackless Pacific. China today is attaining the capability to threaten Japan and Southeast Asia, not solely from the homeland but from its expeditionary bases in the inner seas. From this perspective, the air defense identification zone (ADIZ) that Beijing established in the East China Sea in November 2013 is another element in its attempt to establish control over the inner skies of Asia. An Asiatic Mediterranean dominated by China would severely limit America's global strategic freedom, and potentially threaten our nation's economic well-being.

IV.

What is to be done?

First, the United States must consciously redraw its mental map to adopt the idea of the Asiatic Mediterranean. Stretching from Kamchatka in the north to the Strait of Malacca in the south, its interconnected waters form the soft underbelly of Asia. Washington must then accept that its goal is to ensure that no aggressive power gains control over the Asiatic Mediterranean and thereby threatens the region's stability. This policy is a combination of maintaining the balance of power and asserting America's ability to control the waters, skies, and cyber networks of East Asia's inner seas, if necessary.

This requires several policy adaptations. First, US Indo-Pacific Command must ensure its planning and operations seamlessly cover the entire space and can maintain control when called upon, particularly at strategic checkpoints. The ability to overwhelmingly target Chinese ships in the early stages of a conflict, operate in the face of cyberattacks, and maintain control of the skies throughout the inner sea area is vital. This will help ensure that the Pentagon's goal of "preparedness"